

TIMELINE

- **July 31, 1816** Born, one of nine children, on a small plantation in Southampton County, Virginia.
- **1836** Enters West Point. Befriends William Tecumseh Sherman while at the Academy.
- **1840** Graduates from West Point. Commissioned Second Lieutenant in the 3rd Artillery.
- **1841-1842** Serves with distinction in the Seminole Wars.
- **1843-1847** Posted to forts and installations including Fort McHenry and New Orleans.
- **1847** Serves at Monterrey and Buena Vista during the War with Mexico. Brevetted to major.



BATTLE OF BUENA VISTA

- **1851-1853** Instructor of Cavalry and Artillery at West Point. Marries Frances Lucretia Kellogg.
- **1855** Serves at Fort Yuma and is promoted to major in the Regulars, then posted to the 2nd Cavalry in Texas where he serves under both Col. Albert S. Johnston and Lt. Col. Robert E. Lee.
- **1861** Remains loyal to the Union when Virginia secedes. Promoted to colonel and then brigadier general. Serves in the Shenandoah Valley and then transfers west to Kentucky.